STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-5610

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 10/03/08	DATE REVISED **03/03/17**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES
SUBJECT INTERNSHIP PROGRAM	CROSS REFERENCE

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for student interns.

II. Policy:

As a supplement to paid, full and part-time non-sworn employees, the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office utilizes the services of selected student interns. The Sheriff's Office encourages participation by student interns to assist the department in research and support functions. The Internship Program shall be under the supervision of the Professional Standards Unit Commander and under the immediate direction and coordination of the Training Sergeant. The Sheriff shall reserve the right to determine the duties, schedules and acceptance of all interns.

III. Procedures:

A. Application Procedures: Any intern requesting to enter the program shall submit a written request to the Professional Standards Unit Commander. After receipt of a written request, the Training Sergeant shall ensure the following are completed.

1. The intern shall complete an Application form including an Authorization for Release of Information Agreement.

a) Interns must be citizens of the United States (or members of the United States Military) and of good character.

b) Felony or serious misdemeanor convictions shall disqualify applicants from further consideration.

2. A complete background investigation shall be completed however; a polygraph examination shall not be administered to unpaid interns.

3. After the completion of the background investigation, the Training Sergeant shall submit the information to the Professional Standards Unit Commander who shall review the intern's background. If approved by the Professional Standards Unit Commander, the information shall be forwarded to the Sheriff for final approval.

B. Orientation Procedures: The Training Sergeant shall provide orientation to all approved interns.

1. Prior to orientation, the Professional Standards Unit Commander and Training Sergeant shall determine what duties the intern shall be performing and shall determine which supervisor the intern shall report to.

a) Duties assigned to interns shall not include law enforcement functions that would require the authority of a sworn deputy.

b) Assigned duties may vary at the direction of the assigned supervisor but shall generally support organizational units and community relation activities.

2. The Training Sergeant, at orientation, shall have the intern sign a Release from Responsibility for Participation as an Unpaid Student Intern form and a Confidentiality Agreement form.

3. The Training Sergeant shall issue a Sheriff's Office Photo Identification.

4. Interns shall be advised that they have the same responsibilities as paid staff regarding the adherence to Sheriff's Office Policy and Procedure and shall be provided access to a copy of all relevant SOPs.

5. The Training Sergeant and the intern's supervisor shall review the duties and responsibilities of the position and shall introduce the intern to the employees he or she shall be interacting with on a regular basis and shall provide an overview of the Sheriff's Office structure.

6. The intern's direct supervisor shall ensure that the intern receives all appropriate training to complete the assigned duties. This training shall be coordinated with the Training Sergeant.

C. Program Procedures:

1. Interns shall report directly to their assigned supervisor. The assigned supervisor shall be responsible for completing and signing any associated

documentation (e.g. Internship hours, etc.). Copies of all related documentation shall be forwarded to the Training Sergeant.

2. In the case of disciplinary action or unsatisfactory performance, the assigned supervisor shall notify and coordinate with the Training Sergeant.

3. Interns shall wear their issued identification at all times when "on-duty" or in any Sheriff's Office facility. The wearing or display of Intern identification off duty shall be prohibited.

4. Work performed by interns which is confidential or sensitive in nature shall not be discussed with anyone except those deputies or non-sworn staff personnel with an operational need to know.

5. Interns shall not drive Sheriff's Office vehicles.

D. **Training Sergeant Responsibilities:** The Training Sergeant shall maintain oversight over the program including the following:

1. Recruit, interview, and maintain a current list of potential interns for available positions.

2. Respond to requests from command officers and supervisors regarding the program. Command officers or supervisors wishing to establish an intern position in their division/unit shall prepare a position description describing the duties and responsibilities. This shall be forwarded to the Training Sergeant.

3. Maintain a list of potential intern assignments within the Sheriff's Office.

4. Maintain a file for each intern including all application forms and relevant documentation.

E. **Successful Internship Completion:** An internship shall be deemed successful upon receipt of:

1. A favorable evaluation and recommendation from the intern's assigned supervisor during the internship program.

2. A favorable evaluation and recommendation from the Training Sergeant at the completion of the internship. The Training Sergeant's recommendation shall ensure the intern has completed:

a) A written essay of 1000 words summarizing the interns experience and training while in the program.

b) A minimum of 156 hours of service for the Sheriff's Office while in the program.